Definitions of Trigonometric Functions

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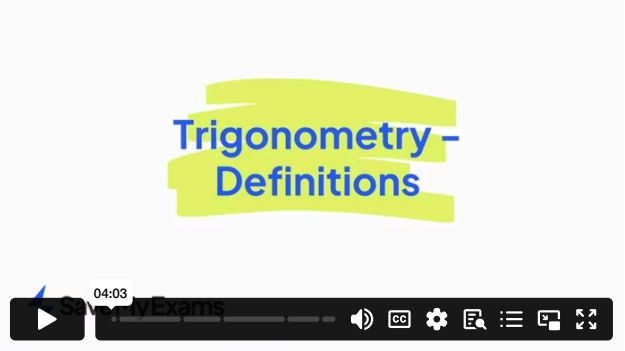

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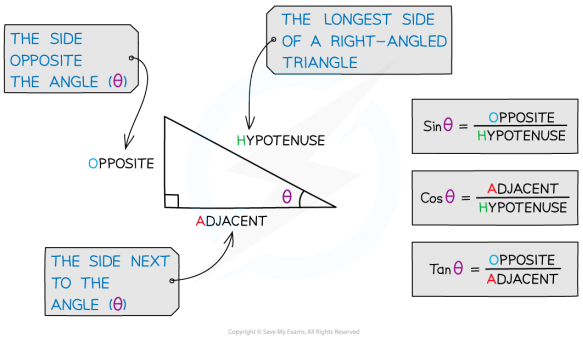
Help me understand

Definitions of trigonometric functions

What is trigonometry?

- Trigonometry looks at the relationship between side lengths and angles of triangles
- It comes from the Greek words trigonon meaning 'triangle' and metron meaning 'measure'
- The three trigonometric functions Sine, Cosine and Tangent come from ratios of side lengths in right angled triangles



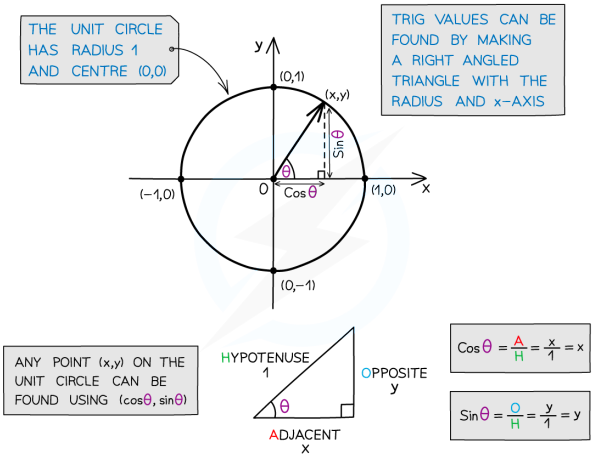
Stuck on something?

Ask questions and get help with exactly what you're revising.

Got it

trigonometry?

- The unit circle is a circle with radius 1 and centre (0, 0)
- It can be used to calculate trig values as a co-ordinate point (x, y) on the circle
- (x, y) = (cos θ, sin θ), where θ is the angle measured anticlockwise from the positive x-axis
- It allows us to calculate **sin**, **cos** and **tan** for angles greater than 90°



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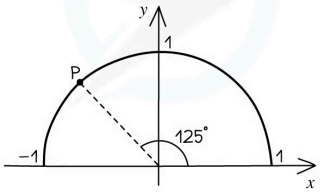
Worked Example

a) The co-ordinates of a point on the unit circle, to 3 s.f., are (0.629, 0.777).
Find θ to the nearest degree.

b) Find the coordinates of point P on the unit circle.
Give your answer to 2 d.p.



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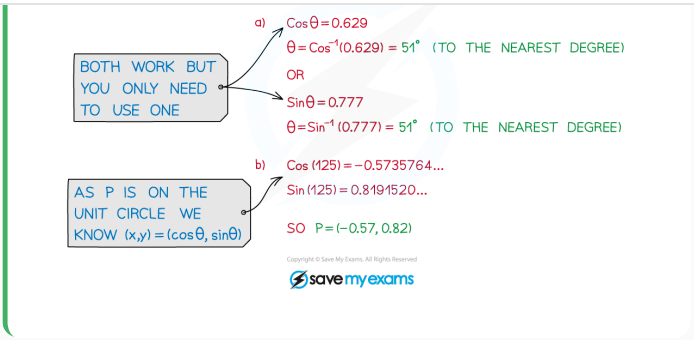

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